To Whom It May Concern,

I am pleased to support **NUTRIX LAB – The Food Interaction Map**, a student project developed by Jeyla Ahmadzada, Youssef El Haroun, Mikayil Ahmadbayli, Farah Haji, and Jamal Naghizade. I highly value the project's effort to bring nutrition research together with traditional family cooking.

To study how ingredients within a single dish interact with one another, the students developed a nutrient compatibility matrix, a laboratory protocol, and a composite Food Interaction Score. A particularly valuable contribution was their documentation of 25 family recipes. Through conversations with parents and grandparents, they recorded each dish's ingredients, preparation methods, and the stories behind it, treating Mediterranean culinary culture as a genuine source of knowledge.

The team then analyzed these traditional dishes one by one, examining each recipe's ingredients, proportions, and cooking methods to identify where its nutritional balance could be improved. Using the compatibility matrix and the Food Interaction Score, the students created healthier versions of these dishes while preserving each recipe's familiar taste and cultural character. The result is a set of recipe cards with preparation instructions and clear explanations of what was changed in each dish and why.

In my view, the project's greatest strength is the connection it builds between generations, culinary heritage, and scientific learning. Showing that traditional dishes can be made more nutritionally balanced without losing their identity is a valuable and practical message. I would also like to highlight how clearly the team defined the limits of its own research: the recipe changes are based on ingredient and nutrient compatibility analysis, no invasive testing was carried out, and no health-effect claims are made.

NUTRIX LAB demonstrates initiative, originality, and a thoughtful approach to the needs of the community. I am glad to support these five students in their future work.

Sincerely,

Name, Surname: Shumaza Gazafayeva

Position: physician

Signature:

Date: 30/01/2026

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